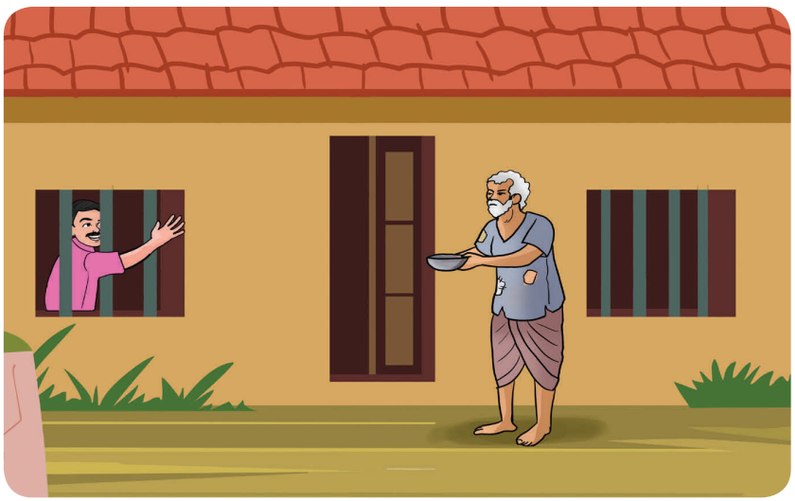


He slowly walked to the next house, and knocked at the door "Is anybody there?" After repeated knocks, a voice answered, "Nobody is home. Try the next house." "If there is no one, then, who is answering me?" asked the old man. The man got irritated and opened the door and said, "Why don't you try the big house in the same street?" The old man sadly replied, "I tried, but he did not offer any food." He asked, "How can you expect me to help you when the richest man of the village **denied**?" The old man left the place.

The old man was tired and could not walk anymore. So he sat under a tree and soon slept. A man in **shabby** clothes woke him and asked "Who are you? Why are you lying here?" The old man replied, "I have no food and no place to stay." The poor man said, "You look tired and hungry, come to my home and stay with us." The old man replied, "I don't want to be a burden to you, I just need some food." The poor man said, "Okay, just come and have some food with us." He took the old man to his hut.

The hut was very small and barely enough for the family. The old man saw that the house wouldn't withstand the monsoon. The house had no furniture, but only a few utensils were there for use. The people in the house, a lady and two children, were very happy to welcome the old man in. They made him sit comfortably. The children sat near him. The man introduced himself and his family, "I am Kaliyan. I work in the farm nearby. This is my wife Viji and my children Gopi and Rathika." Soon the children got close to the old man. They asked



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